



Select firm, ripe fruit free of mold or damage, wash thoroughly, and remove stems, pits, or seeds as required by the recipe.

STEP

1

Making Fruit Preserves



Mash or chop the fruit with a potato masher or knife as appropriate for the recipe, measuring accurately.

STEP

2

Making Fruit Preserves



Combine fruit, sugar, and any added pectin or lemon juice according to recipe. Heat the mixture in a large saucepan over high heat, stirring constantly.

STEP

3

Making Fruit Preserves



Bring the mixture to a full rolling boil over high heat, stirring frequently to prevent burning, until thickened to the desired consistency or to 220 deg F (8 deg F above boiling point of water).

STEP

4

Making Fruit Preserves



Remove from heat and quickly skim off any foam from the surface to improve clarity and appearance.

STEP

5

Making Fruit Preserves



Ladle or pour the hot preserves into sterilized canning jars leaving 1/4 inch headspace; wipe jar rims to ensure a clean seal.

! SAFETY STEP

STEP

6

Making Fruit Preserves



Place sterilized flat lids on jars and secure with screw bands fingertip tight to allow air to escape during processing.

! SAFETY STEP

STEP

7

Making Fruit Preserves



Process the filled jars in a boiling water bath canner for 5 minutes for half-pints and pints (adjust for altitude as needed).

! SAFETY STEP

STEP

8

Making Fruit Preserves



After processing time is complete, turn off the heat, remove the canner lid carefully, and wait 5 minutes before removing jars to prevent siphoning.

! SAFETY STEP

STEP

9

Making Fruit Preserves



Cool jars undisturbed on a rack or towel at room temperature for 12-24 hours to allow proper sealing.

! SAFETY STEP

STEP

10

Making Fruit Preserves



Check lids for sealed concavity and resistance; remove screw bands and store jars in a cool, dark, dry place.

! SAFETY STEP

STEP

11

Making Fruit Preserves



If any jars do not seal properly, refrigerate and use within a few weeks to prevent spoilage and foodborne illness.

! SAFETY STEP

STEP

12

Making Fruit Preserves